

HOUSEKEEPING TOOLBOX TALK

Maintain clear walkways, organised work areas and safe waste control.

8-10 MINUTES

OBJECTIVE

Review slip, trip, fall, fire and access hazards caused by poor housekeeping, waste, spills, unsafe storage and obstructed walkways, and maintain an orderly work area throughout the task.

TOPIC EXPLANATION

- Housekeeping is not limited to cleaning at the end of the job. Materials, tools, cables, hoses, packaging and waste must be controlled safely throughout the work.
- A small item in a walkway, an unsecured cable or an oil spill can cause a serious injury. Poor housekeeping can also block emergency exits, firefighting equipment and rescue access.
- Each team is responsible for its own work area. Waste must be segregated, materials must be stored securely and unnecessary equipment must be removed as the work progresses.

REALISTIC SITE SCENARIO

- A maintenance team left cable pieces, packaging and unused equipment in a platform walkway.
- During the shift change, another worker entered the area, tripped over a cable and dropped equipment to a lower level.
- The incident could have been prevented by keeping walkways clear, removing waste immediately and inspecting the area before handing over the shift.

REMEMBER

A clean and organised workplace does more than look professional; it prevents falls, fires, equipment damage and delays during emergencies.

HOUSEKEEPING TOOLBOX TALK

Hazards, control measures and daily pre-work verification.

8-10 MINUTES

KEY HAZARDS

- Cables, hoses, materials and waste in walkways.
- Oil, water or chemical spills.
- Unsafe or unstable material storage.
- Blocked emergency exits or firefighting equipment.
- Sharp metal and packaging waste.
- Excessive material stored on platforms or scaffolds.
- Flammable waste stored in unsuitable containers.
- Tools and leftover materials abandoned after work.

CONTROL MEASURES

- Keep access and escape routes clear at all times.
- Route cables and hoses safely.
- Clean spills immediately and mark the area.
- Place waste in correctly labelled containers.
- Store materials securely and in a stable condition.
- Keep firefighting equipment and panels accessible.
- Dispose of sharp waste in suitable containers.
- Avoid unnecessary material accumulation on platforms.
- Inspect the work area at the end of the shift.
- Correct or report poor housekeeping immediately.

SUPERVISOR TALKING SCRIPT

Team, today we will maintain good housekeeping throughout the task, not only at the end. We will not leave cables, hoses, waste or unnecessary materials in walkways. Any spill will be controlled and cleaned immediately. Emergency exits and firefighting equipment must remain accessible. Each team is responsible for its own work area.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- Are today's access and escape routes completely clear?
- Have cables and hoses been routed safely?
- Where are the waste containers and are they correctly labelled?
- Who will respond if a spill occurs?
- Is firefighting equipment fully accessible?
- Who will inspect the area at the end of the shift?

VERIFY BEFORE STARTING TODAY

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Walkways clear | ☐ Emergency exits clear |
| ☐ Cables organised | ☐ Hoses routed safely |
| ☐ Waste containers ready | ☐ Storage stable |
| ☐ No spills present | ☐ Fire equipment accessible |
| ☐ Platforms clean | ☐ Area owner identified |

ATTENDANCE AND APPROVAL

HOUSEKEEPING TOOLBOX TALK

Project / Site

Date

Presented by

Work area

No	Full Name	Company / Role	Signature
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
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Supervisor notes / additional site instructions